

BENNY'S BURGER PIZ

FULL GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

Genre: Narrative Survival Horror

Platform: PC

Engine: Unity

Perspective: First-Person

Developer: Solo / Indie

1. HIGH CONCEPT

Benny's Burger Piz is a first-person psychological horror game set during a late-night shift in a remote roadside diner. The player performs mundane tasks while an unseen entity manipulates the environment and mimics familiar voices, creating distrust in sound, memory, and routine.

2. DESIGN PILLARS

- Psychological Horror over Combat – Fear is generated through anticipation, sound design, and environmental change rather than fighting.
- Unreliable Audio – Voices, phone calls, and instructions cannot be trusted and actively mislead the player.
- Small Space, Deep Tension – A compact level is reused and distorted to maximize familiarity-based fear.
- Player Vulnerability – The player has no means of attack and must rely on awareness and decision-making.

3. TARGET AUDIENCE

Fans of indie psychological horror games, narrative-driven experiences, and stream-friendly horror titles. Appeals to players who enjoy slow-burn tension and environmental storytelling.

4. CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

- Explore the diner and observe environmental details
- Complete assigned tasks (cleaning, cooking, answering calls)
- Experience scripted and dynamic horror events
- Make narrative or behavioral choices
- Environment and entity react to player behavior
- Progress story and unlock new disturbances

5. PLAYER EXPERIENCE GOALS

The player should feel constantly observed, uncertain about what information is real, and emotionally pressured by familiar voices. Fear should escalate gradually, peaking near the end without relying on frequent jumpscares.

6. NARRATIVE OVERVIEW

Mia Carter, a 19-year-old college student, works a late shift at Benny's Burger Piz. As the night progresses, phone calls become disturbing, the diner subtly rearranges itself, and an entity begins to imitate people Mia trusts. The diner is revealed to be a predatory space that feeds on fear and identity.

7. PLAYER MECHANICS

Movement: Walk, Sprint (stamina-limited)

Interaction: Context-sensitive interaction with objects and environment

Observation: Visual and audio cues replace traditional UI guidance

8. CORE HORROR SYSTEMS

Voice Mimic System: The entity mimics coworkers, managers, and emergency voices to mislead the player.

Dynamic Environment Shifts: Lighting, room layout, and object placement subtly change as the story progresses.

9. ENEMY DESIGN

The antagonist is never fully visible. It manifests through shadows, reflections, audio cues, and voice imitation. Direct confrontation results in immediate failure, reinforcing helplessness.

10. LEVEL DESIGN

The game takes place in a single diner consisting of a dining area, kitchen, storage room, restroom, and office. The layout remains recognizable while progressively distorting to exploit player familiarity.

11. AUDIO DESIGN

Audio is the primary horror driver, using ambient noise, silence, distorted voices, and positional sound to control tension and pacing.

12. ENDINGS

- Escape Ending – Mia survives and leaves the diner
- Assimilation Ending – Mia becomes part of the diner
- Destruction Ending – The diner is destroyed (secret ending)

13. TECHNICAL & PRODUCTION NOTES

Developed in Unity for PC as a solo project. Systems are modular and designed for reuse. Free or low-cost assets are prioritized to maintain indie feasibility.

Minimum System Requirements (PC)

OS: Windows 10 (64-bit)

Processor: Intel Core i3 (8th Gen) / AMD Ryzen 3 1200

Memory: 8 GB RAM

Graphics: NVIDIA GTX 750 Ti / AMD Radeon R7 260X

DirectX: Version 11

Storage: 5 GB available space

Sound Card: DirectX compatible